More about ecosystems

☞ **1** Unscramble the letters in brackets, and then write in the new words to complete this general information about ecosystems.

Living creatures of all kinds need (doof) _____, water and shelter. To obtain food, some living things (tea) _____ other living things in their ecosystem. We show these relationships in a (diamarg) _____ called a food web.

In every ecosystem, there is a source of drinking (tawer) _____. It may be a (ereck) _____ or pond or it may be deep under the (drongu) _____.

Most living things need clean (ria) _____ to breathe, as well as the right amount of (tighl) _____ or darkness and a way of keeping their body temperature warm or (loco) _____ enough. To shelter themselves and their offspring, animals make (shome) _____ in the plants, rocks, soil and other natural features of an ecosystem.

An animal's ideal home is often a place that offers protection from predators, shelter from harsh weather conditions and a feeling of (tafesy) _____. The environment most suitable for a particular living thing's survival is called its (bitahat) _____.

Energy and nutrients

All the living things and non-living things in an ecosystem are involved in the flow of **energy** and **nutrients**. Energy enters the ecosystem as sunlight (light energy) and is made into food by green plants. Some animals eat the plants and other animals eat these animals. When animals and plants die, organisms such as fungi break down the remains into small parts called nutrients, which go into the soil and are then used by new green plants. The **cycle** begins again.

2 Draw a line between each sentence starter and the most appropriate sentence ending.

a) Green plants	eat plants and release the energy in the food.
b) Animals	use energy from sunlight to create their own food.
c) Decomposers such as fungi	break down animal and plant remains into small parts.

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More about ecosystems CONT'D

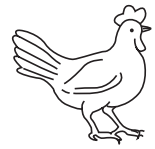
3 **a)** Circle four or more pictures that show living things that might come from the same ecosystem. Name the ecosystem.

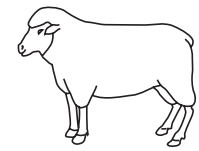




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b) Use a different colour to circle another four or more pictures that show living things from another ecosystem. Name the ecosystem.

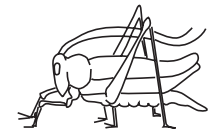




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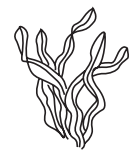
c) Which, if any, of the living things are included in both your ecosystems?





_____

4 Write at least two plants found in each type of ecosystem listed below. The first one has been done for you.


a) a snowy, alpine forest fir trees, moss

b) a hot, dry desert _____

c) the Australian bush _____

d) a garden pond _____

e) a tropical rainforest _____



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